

Navigating the Publishing Process: Scholarly Books and Open Research in STEM



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The True Size of Africa

A small contribution in the fight against rampant *Immappancy*, by Kai Krause

Graphic layout for visualization only (some countries are cut and rotated)
But the conclusions are very accurate: refer to table below for exact data

COUNTRY	AREA x 1000 km ²
China	9.597
USA	9.629
India	3.287
Mexico	1.964
Peru	1.285
France	633
Spain	506
Papua New Guinea	462
Sweden	441
Japan	378
Germany	357
Norway	324
Italy	301
New Zealand	270
United Kingdom	243
Nepal	147
Bangladesh	144
Greece	132
TOTAL	30.102
AFRICA	30.221

In addition to the well known social issues of *illiteracy* and *innumeracy*, there also should be such a concept as "*immappancy*", meaning *insufficient geographical knowledge*.

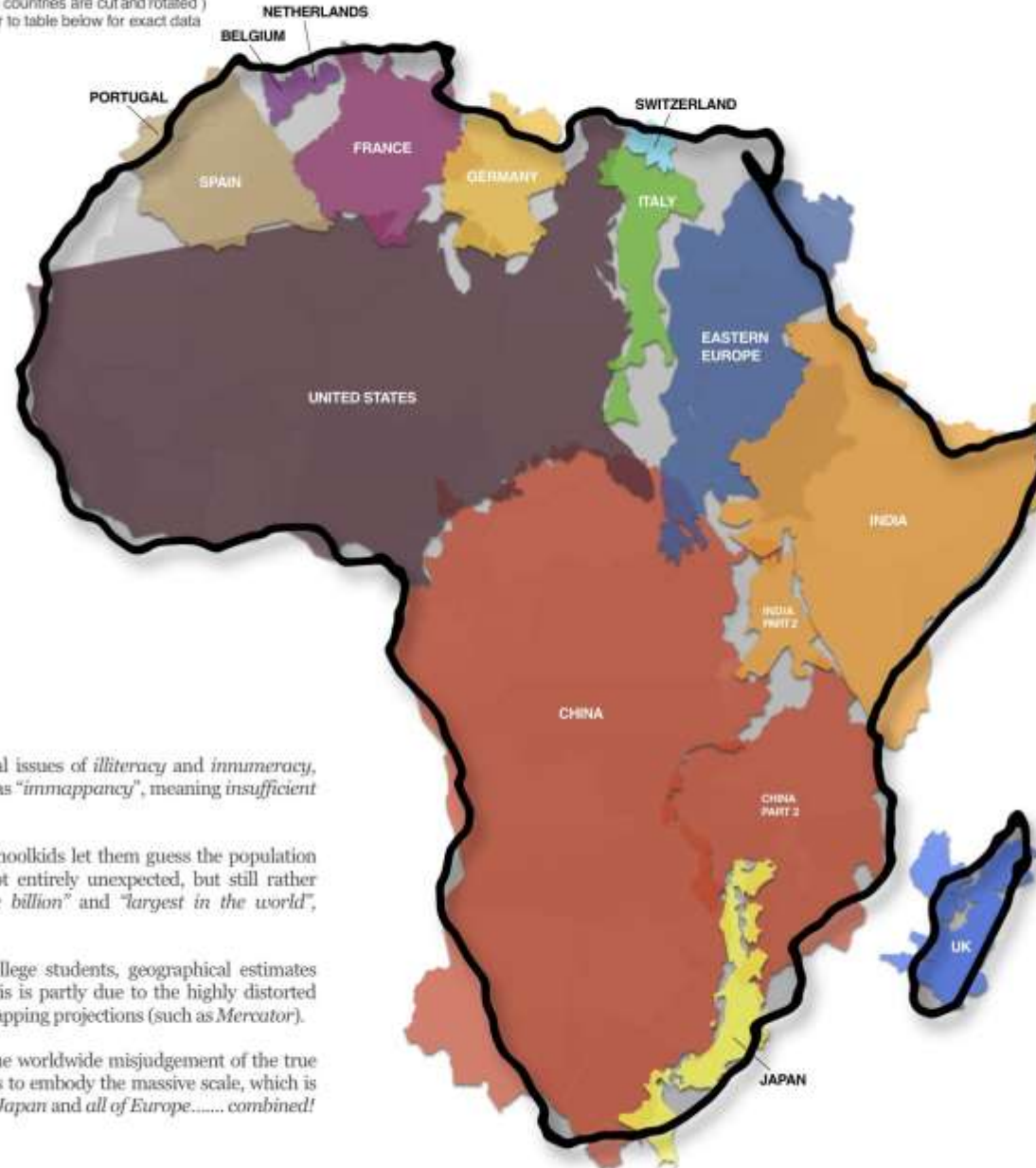
A survey with random American schoolkids let them guess the population and land area of their country. Not entirely unexpected, but still rather unsettling, the majority chose "*1-2 billion*" and "*largest in the world*", respectively.

Even with Asian and European college students, geographical estimates were often off by factors of 2-3. This is partly due to the highly distorted nature of the predominantly used mapping projections (such as *Mercator*).

A particularly extreme example is the worldwide misjudgement of the true size of *Africa*. This single image tries to embody the massive scale, which is larger than the *USA*, *China*, *India*, *Japan* and *all of Europe*..... combined!

Top 100 Countries

Area in square kilometers, Percentage of World Total
Sources: Britannica, Wikipedia, Almanac 2010



	AREA	%	
1	Russia	17.098.242	11,20
2	Canada	9.984.870	6,70
3	China	9.596.961	6,40
4	United States	9.529.081	6,40
5	Brazil	8.511.877	5,70
6	Australia	7.692.024	5,20
7	India	3.287.263	2,30
8	Argentina	2.780.400	2,00
9	Kazakhstan	2.724.800	1,80
10	Sudan	2.526.813	1,70
11	Algeria	2.381.741	1,60
12	Congo	2.344.858	1,60
13	Greenland	2.166.086	1,50
14	Saudi Arabia	2.149.850	1,40
15	Mexico	1.964.375	1,30
16	Indonesia	1.880.260	1,30
17	Libya	1.752.846	1,20
18	Iran	1.628.750	1,10
19	Myanmar	1.564.100	1,10
20	Peru	1.285.218	0,96
21	Chad	1.284.060	0,96
22	Niger	1.267.000	0,85
23	Angola	1.246.700	0,85
24	Mali	1.240.180	0,85
25	South Africa	1.221.037	0,82
26	Colombia	1.141.748	0,76
27	Ethiopia	1.104.300	0,74
28	Bolivia	1.098.581	0,74
29	Mauritania	1.025.520	0,69
30	Egypt	1.002.000	0,67
31	Tanzania	945.067	0,65
32	Nigeria	903.768	0,62
33	Venezuela	912.550	0,61
34	Norway	824.116	0,55
35	Mozambique	801.590	0,54
36	Pakistan	796.098	0,53
37	Turkey	783.562	0,53
38	Chile	756.100	0,51
39	Zambia	752.612	0,51
40	Myanmar	676.578	0,45
41	Afghanistan	652.050	0,44
42	Yemen	527.967	0,43
43	France	632.834	0,43
44	C. African Rep	622.984	0,42
45	Ukraine	603.500	0,41
46	Madagascar	587.041	0,39
47	Botswana	582.035	0,39
48	Kenya	580.367	0,39
49	Yemen	527.968	0,36
50	Thailand	513.120	0,34
51	Spain	505.990	0,34
52	Turkmenistan	468.100	0,33
53	Cameroon	475.442	0,32
54	Papua New Guinea	462.840	0,31
55	Uzbekistan	447.500	0,30
56	Morocco	446.850	0,30
57	Sweden	441.370	0,30
58	Iraq	438.317	0,29
59	Paraguay	408.752	0,27
60	Zimbabwe	390.757	0,26
61	Japan	377.930	0,25
62	Germany	357.021	0,24
63	Rep. of Congo	342.000	0,23
64	Finland	338.419	0,23
65	Vietnam	331.212	0,22
66	Malaysia	330.858	0,22
67	Norway	303.801	0,22
68	Côte d'Ivoire	322.463	0,22
69	Poland	312.685	0,21
70	Oman	309.500	0,21
71	Italy	301.536	0,20
72	Philippines	298.000	0,20
73	Burkina Faso	274.202	0,18
74	New Zealand	270.467	0,18
75	Colombia	287.658	0,18
76	Western Sahara	266.000	0,18
77	Ecuador	258.269	0,20
78	Guinea	245.867	0,17
79	United Kingdom	242.900	0,16
80	Uganda	241.038	0,16
81	Ghana	238.539	0,16
82	Romania	238.291	0,16
83	Laos	236.800	0,16
84	Guyana	214.968	0,14
85	Botswana	207.600	0,14
86	Kyrgyzstan	199.501	0,13
87	Senegal	196.722	0,13
88	Syria	185.180	0,12
89	Cameroon	181.038	0,12
90	Uruguay	178.215	0,12
91	Suriname	163.820	0,11
92	Tunisia	163.610	0,11
93	Nepal	147.181	0,10
94	Bangladesh	143.598	0,10
95	Tajikistan	143.100	0,10
96	Greece	131.987	0,09
97	Nicaragua	130.373	0,09
98	North Korea	120.538	0,08
99	Mali	118.484	0,08
100	Eritrea	117.853	0,08
TOP 100 TOTAL		132.832.524	89,36



United States



Europe



India



Japan



China



African Union Agenda 2063:

Science, Technology and Innovation (STI) as multi-functional tools and an enablers for achieving continental development goals

AU Science, Technology and Innovation Strategy for Africa 2034 (STISA-2034)

Vision

“An integrated, prosperous, and peaceful Africa where science, technology, and innovation drive sustainable socio-economic development.”

Mission

“To harness the transformative power of science, technology, and innovation in accelerating Africa’s transition into a knowledge-based and innovation-driven continent”.

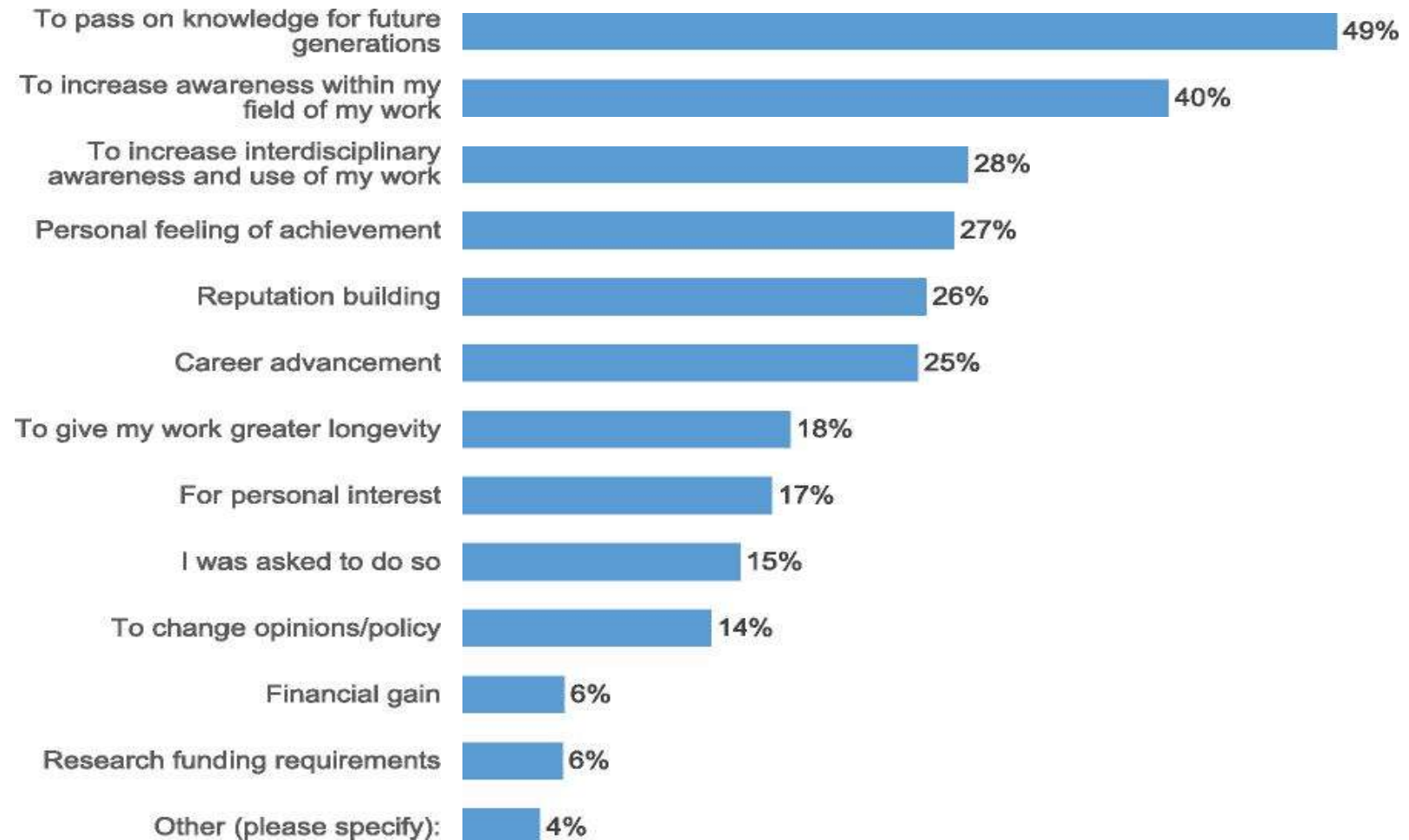
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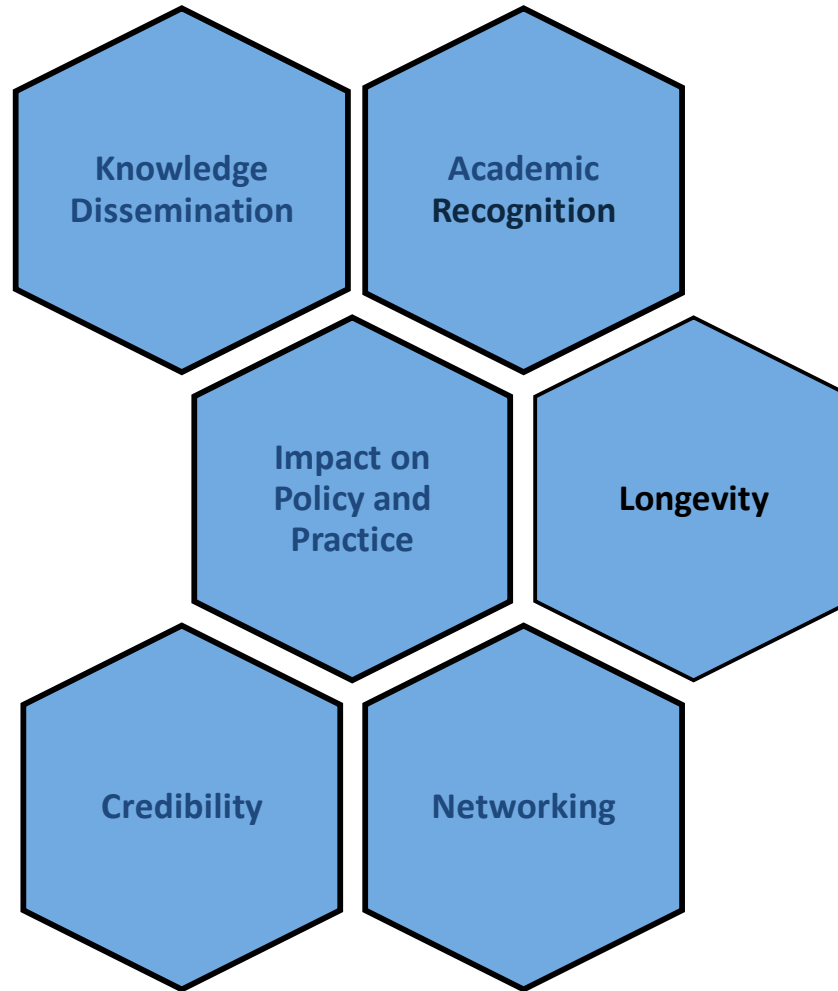


Books

Need for Publishing a Book



Benefits of Publishing Book



Developing your idea

- What is your book about?
- Who is your book for?
- Why does the audience need it or want it?
- What type of book? (Reference, Textbook, Authored, Edited, Professional, Monograph, Handbook)
- What will it do better than the competition?
- Discuss your book idea with:
 - Colleagues
 - Authors published in the field and series editors
 - A commissioning editor

How to start

- Why have you decided to write a book? What type of book you wish to write? Reference, Textbook, Authored, Edited, Professional, Monograph, Handbook
- Consider the TABLE of CONTENTS/KEYWORD technique
- Choose a TITLE
- Consider your market: Competition
- Set a DEADLINE
- Number of PAGES : Less is More!

Essentially, This is your book proposal...

Tips for writing a strong book proposal

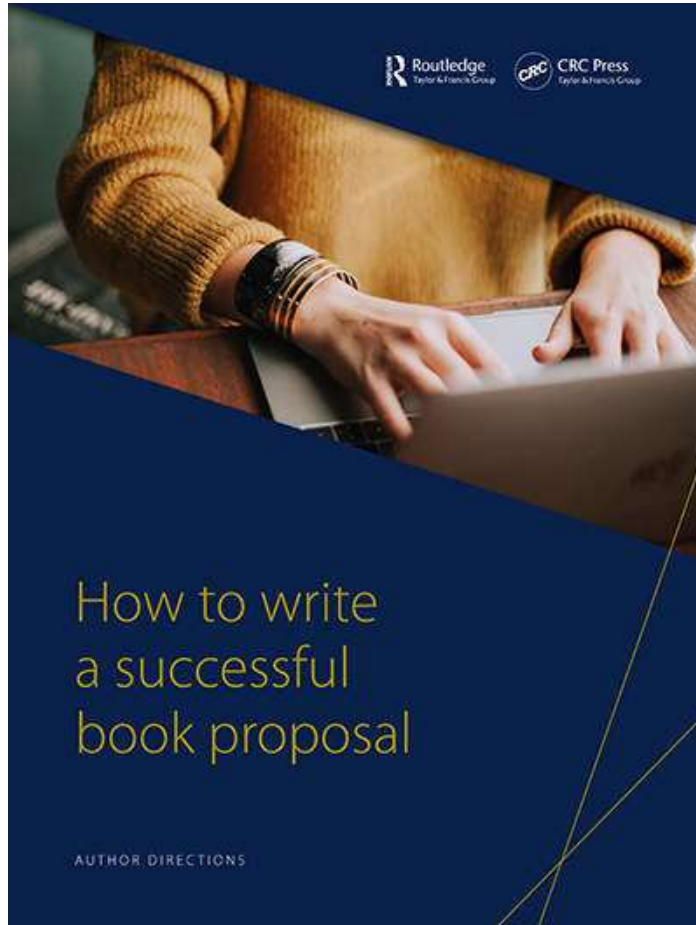
Title - Use a clear title

Market Need – Justify the need of the book

Audience – Include a brief description of your target readership

Table of Contents & Key Features - Include a detailed table of contents with chapter descriptions or abstracts to show how you will set out the content

Competition - Give a brief analysis of some of the most closely related books to your proposed book. How will your book add to existing literature?



The Review Process

- Single-blind review: where the reviewer's name is hidden from the author.
- How many reviews are necessary?
- What is the timeline for the reviews?
- Must I incorporate reviewers' suggestions I don't agree with?
- Why do proposals get rejected? Can a bad review hurt my chances of getting this book published?
- What are you expected to do when you get reviews?

The Writing Phase.....

- How much time a publisher allows author to write a book?
- Sample Chapters
- Understanding the author guidelines
- Asking Questions/Be in touch with publisher
- Manuscript Submission



After you submit the manuscript.....

- Pre-Production Review
- Handover to Production/Project Editor
- Typesetting/Copyediting
- Proofs
- Cover Designing
- Off to Printer
- Book Releases Worldwide



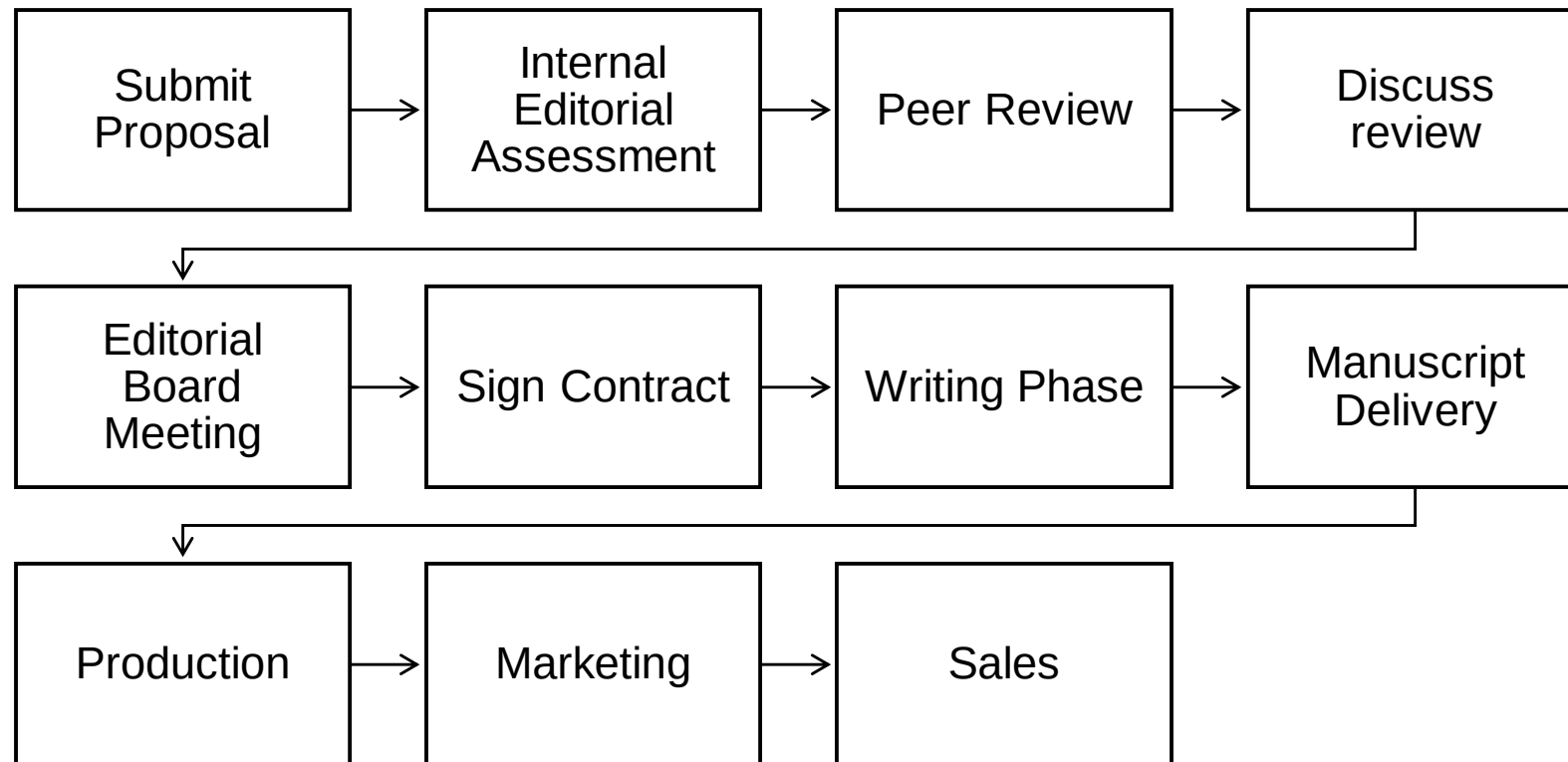
What do prospective authors need to know?

- Compliance with DHET Requirements/MS Review/Timelines
- Royalties
- Copyright Permissions
- Complimentary copies
- TIMELINES/DEADLINES
- Chapter Abstracts
- Indexing (SCOPUS/WoS/Google)
- Flexibility
- Role of EDITOR in a Contributed Book

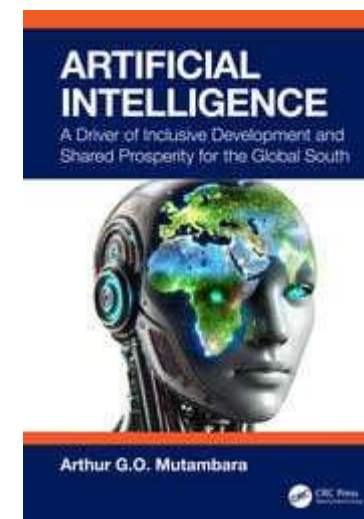
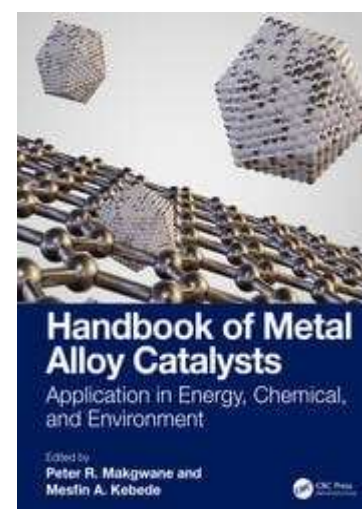
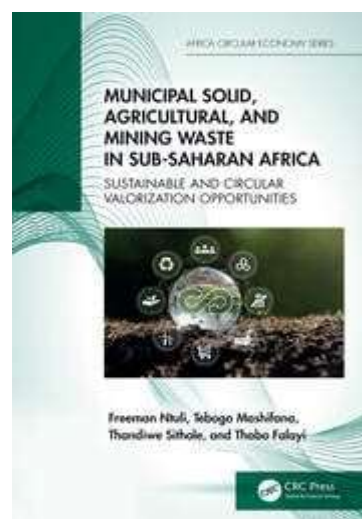
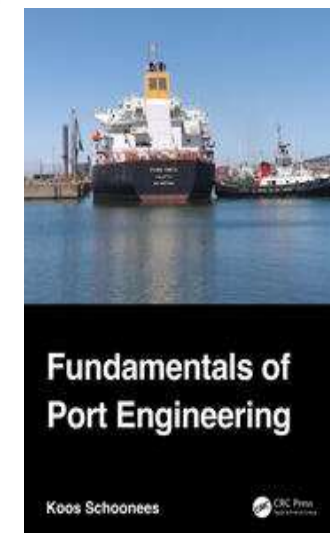
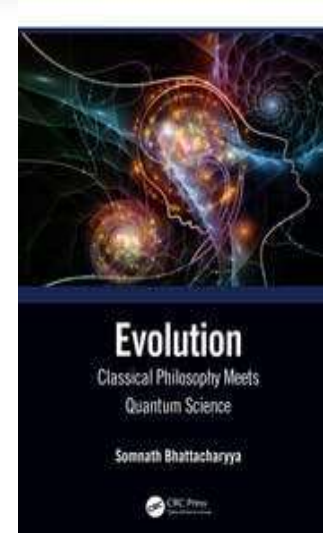
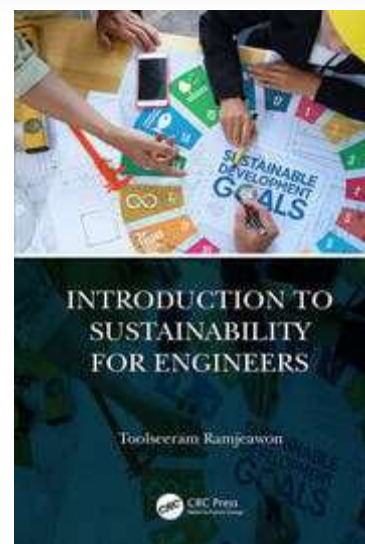
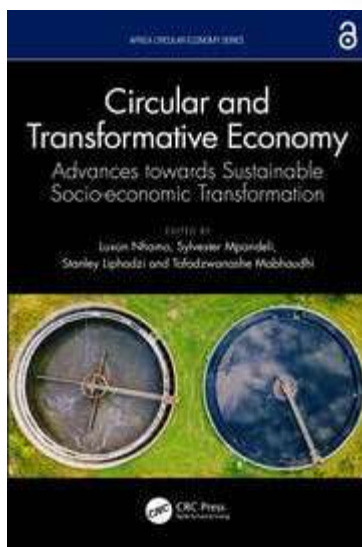
Why do proposals get rejected?

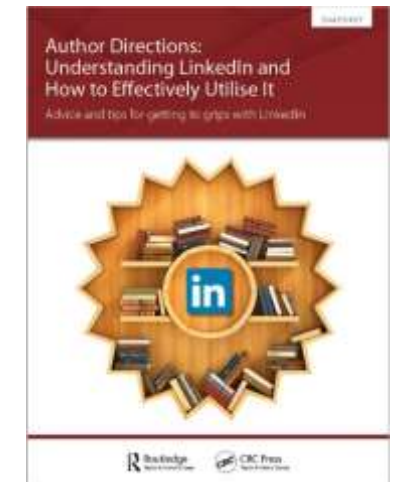
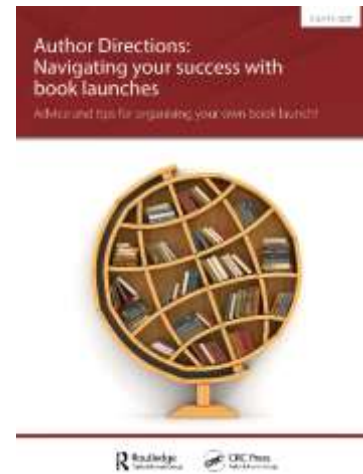
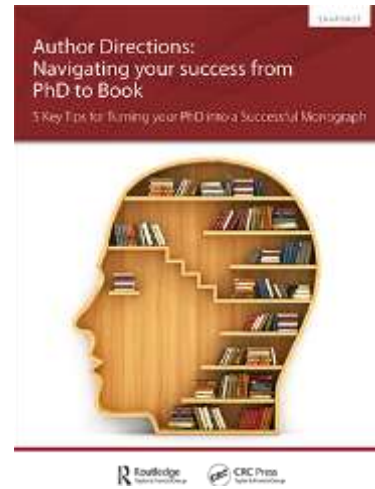
- Absence of unique value proposition
- Sloppily filled proposal form
- Proposals having a very narrow market / written for a very small audience?
- Author's not revising the proposal based on the Editor's / reviewers' suggestions
- Copyright Infringement
- Outside of the scope of the publishing list

Publishing Process

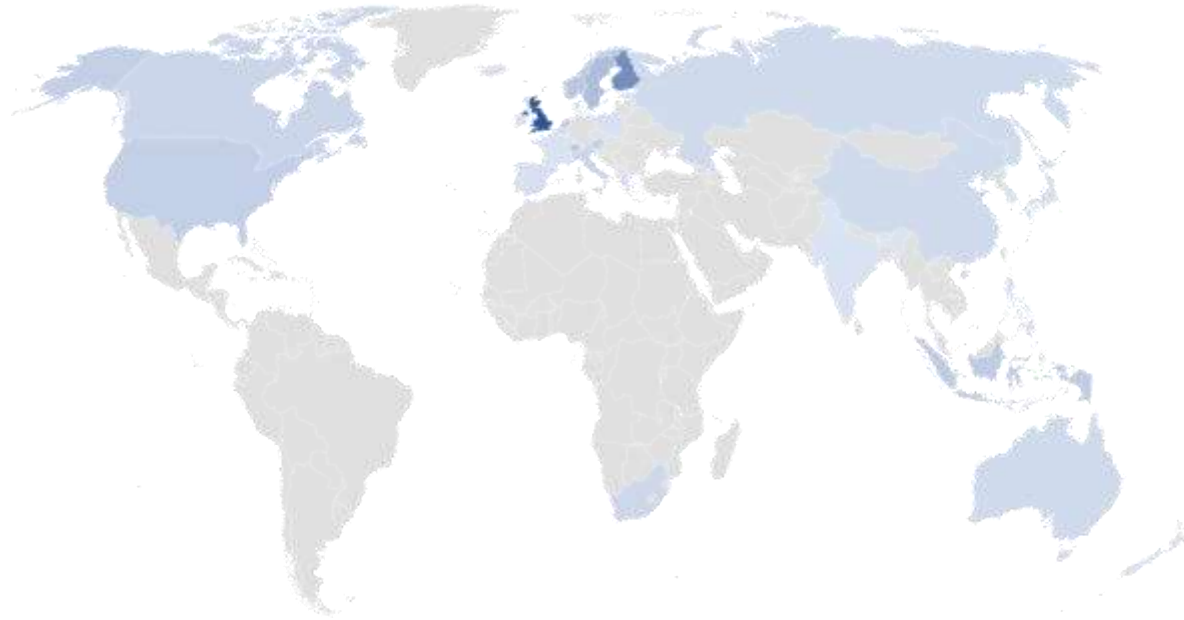


African Authors





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- Anyone, anywhere in the world can read and build upon this research
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Aims of Open Access

UNESCO – reduce the gap between industrialised countries and those in the emerging economy

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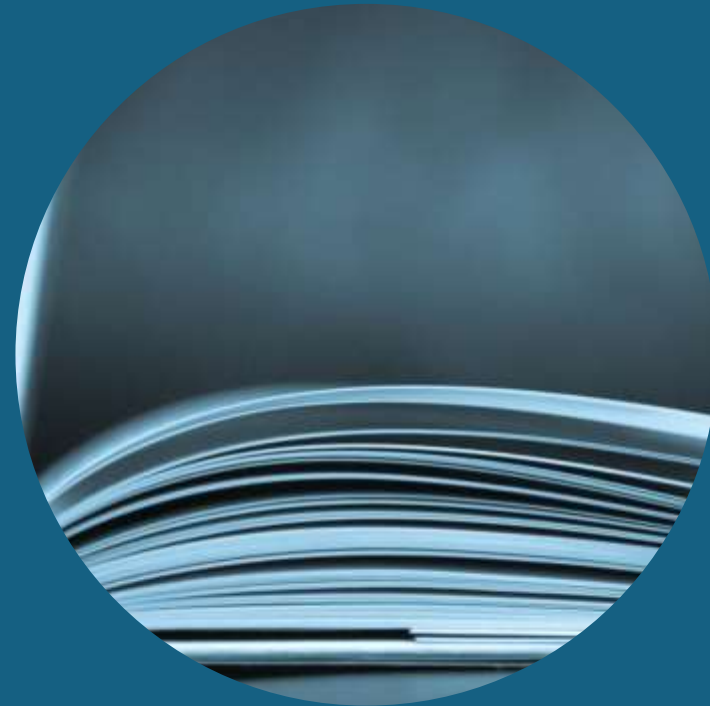


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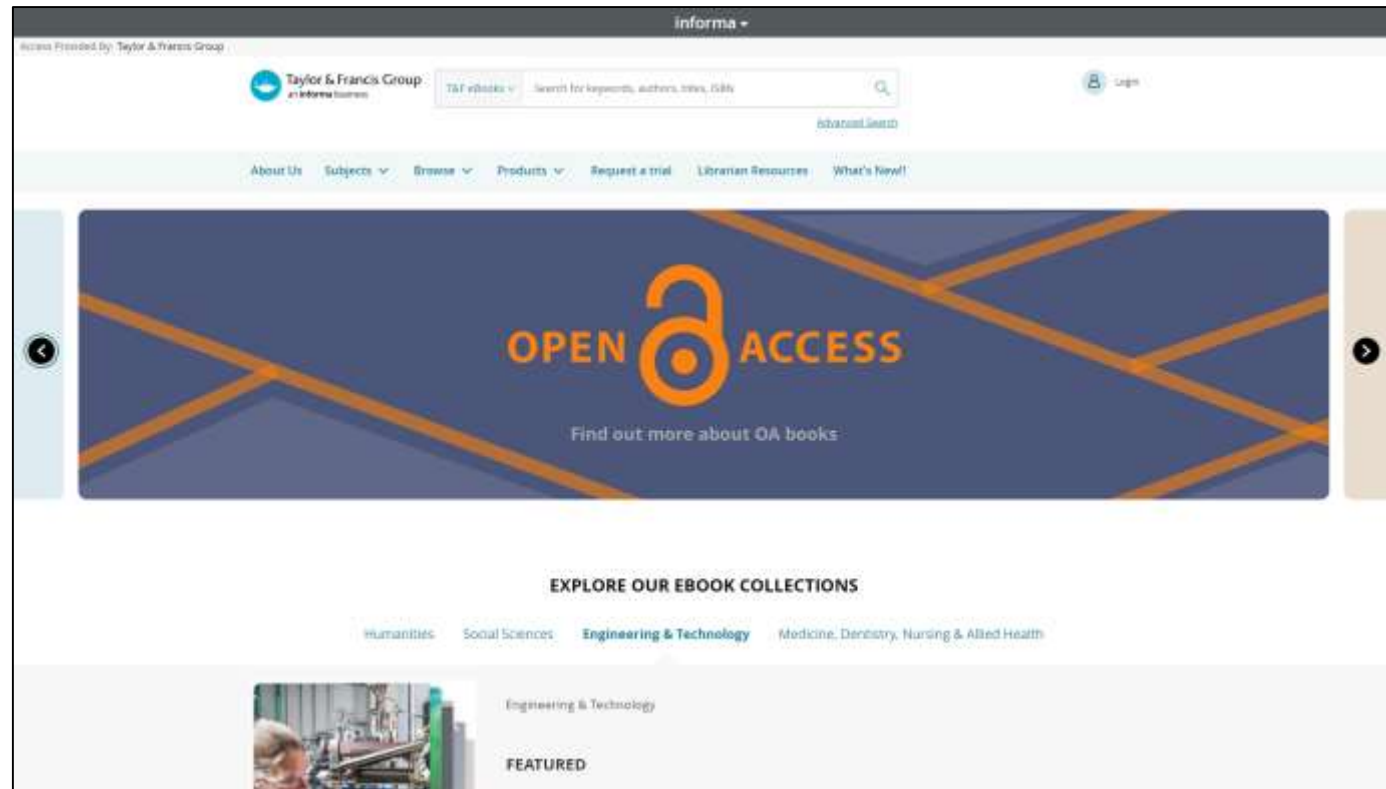
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Book

The Science and Technology of Particle Accelerators

By Rob Appleby, Graeme Burt, James Clarke, Hywel Owen

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First Published	2020
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Subjects	Engineering & Technology, Medicine, Dentistry, Nursing & Allied Health, Physical Sciences
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